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First Evaluation of 3-in-1 Committee Report

The members of the Stretch Product Planning group have finished a first cursory evaluation of the various calculators described in the 3-in-1 report with respect to three areas:

1. B compared to LARC
2. B+S as a satisfaction of the LASL contract
3. B as a commercial processor

If we consider the second and third of the above list we are immediately struck with the conclusion that B+S should be resliced so that more is in S and less is in B so that B's computing ability is brought back in line with its I/O facilities and S's overall performance is speeded up.

If B is reduced in performance its position as a competitor to LARC might be in jeapardy. Also its position in the B+H configuration will have to be examined, but any change in the slicing of B+H is much easier than B+S.

Another possible attack is to improve the I/O facilities of B, but it appears that these would have to improve substantially to bring their performance up to that of B. This solution may not be as easy to acheive as a reslicing of B.

The second round of design and evaluation is now underway. The members of Stretch Product Planning and Stretch Engineering Planning are starting to detail the instructions and data flow paths which will allow a more detailed evaluation of the computer in the near future. In the meanwhile I have Betty McDonough programming the same job she did for Technical Report 001 709-705 III comparison. This is not the best job for complete evaluation of this powerful a computer but it will give us at least one comparative figure.

Examination of B and B+S is proceeding as to a different place to slice B, but no effective place has been found yet. Any major changes in B seem to dictate abandoning the 3-ini approach and starting with a new design for B.

Our examination will continue, however, as a better partitioning may be found.

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